CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

Name: Harshvardhan Singh Rathore

Registration No.: 25BCY10085

Branch: CSE(Cyber Security & Digital Forensics)

Year: 2025-26

Course: B.Tech.

Course Code: BCY

Date: 29/03/2026

Introduction:

This project is part of the Digital Literacy course and is designed to help students develop essential skills for using technology effectively, safely, and responsibly. The main aim is to build awareness about digital tools, online communication, cybersecurity, and professional digital presence. Through a series of practical tasks, students learn how to apply these concepts in real-life situations.

The scenario of the project is based on the role of a “Student Digital Ambassador.” In this role, the student is responsible for guiding peers in navigating the digital world, from creating professional online profiles to practicing safe and ethical online behavior. The project includes tasks such as designing an infographic, building a digital portfolio, practicing coding, understanding email etiquette, and creating awareness about cybercrime. Overall, it helps in building both technical knowledge and practical digital skills required for academic and professional growth.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I used Canva to design my infographic on digital literacy awareness. Canva is a simple and user-friendly tool that helped me create a neat and visually appealing design. It provided many templates, icons, and font styles, which made it easier to organize my ideas and present them clearly. I selected a clean layout with soft colors and simple illustrations so that the information is easy to read and understand.

My design mainly shows the meaning of digital literacy and highlights key areas related to it. These include useful digital tools for students such as Google Classroom, Google Docs, and Canva, along with safe internet practices like using strong passwords and avoiding suspicious links. It also covers maintaining a professional online presence and following proper email etiquette. I arranged the content into sections so that each topic is clearly separated and easy to follow.

One thing I found both interesting and slightly difficult was balancing the amount of text and visuals. I wanted to include enough information without making the infographic look crowded. Choosing the right fonts, spacing, and alignment took time, but it helped improve the overall design. This task helped me understand how to present information effectively while also improving my creativity and design skills.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I chose LinkedIn, GitHub, and Stack Overflow as my main platforms to build a strong digital portfolio. Each of these platforms serves a different but important purpose in my academic and professional growth.

LinkedIn is mainly used for creating a professional profile, connecting with peers, teachers, and industry professionals, and exploring internship or job opportunities. I will keep my profile updated with my education, skills, and achievements, and gradually build a professional network over the next four years.

GitHub is used for sharing and managing coding projects. I plan to upload my assignments, personal projects, and practice work regularly. This will help me track my progress and showcase my technical skills to potential employers.

Stack Overflow is a platform for asking and answering programming-related questions. I will use it to clear my doubts, learn from others' experiences, and eventually contribute by answering questions as my knowledge improves.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use these platforms to learn, grow, and build a strong digital presence that reflects my skills and achievements.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration platforms

For this task, I used **HackerRank** for coding practice and **Google Forms** for collaboration. On HackerRank, I created an account and completed the beginner-level challenge "Solve Me First." This problem helped me understand the basics of input, output, and simple logic building in programming. It was a good starting point to get comfortable with coding environments and problem-solving techniques.

For the collaboration part, I created a Google Form as a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" for my classmates. The form included five questions, out of which four were multiple-choice questions and one was a short answer type. This helped me learn how to design quizzes, structure questions clearly, and collect responses efficiently using Google Workspace tools.

These platforms will help me academically in many ways over time. HackerRank will improve my coding skills, logical thinking, and problem-solving ability, which are important for exams and technical interviews. Google Forms will help me in creating surveys, quizzes, and collecting data for projects or research work. Overall, using these tools has improved both my technical and practical skills, which will support my academic growth.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

One situation where poor digital communication caused a problem is when a student sent an email to a professor without a clear subject line and with incomplete information about an assignment doubt. The message was short, informal, and did not mention the course name or specific issue. As a result, the professor misunderstood the query and gave a general reply, which did not solve the student's problem. This led to confusion and the student submitted the assignment incorrectly, affecting their marks.

This situation could have been avoided by using proper email etiquette. The student should have written a clear subject line, included relevant details, and explained the problem properly. Using a polite tone and structured message would have made the communication clearer and more effective.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

While researching phishing, what surprised me the most was how realistic fake messages and websites can look. Attackers are able to copy official logos, email formats, and even website designs so closely that it becomes very difficult to identify whether they are genuine or not. I also found it surprising how attackers use urgency, like warning about account suspension, to make people panic and act quickly without thinking.

As a result of this, one habit I will personally change is being more careful before clicking on any links or sharing personal information online. I will always verify the sender's email address, check the website URL properly, and avoid responding to messages that create unnecessary urgency. This will help me stay more secure online.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, this project helped me gain a clear understanding of digital literacy and its importance in today's world. Through the different tasks, I learned how to use digital tools effectively, create a professional online presence, and communicate properly in academic and professional settings. I also developed basic coding skills and became more aware of cyber threats like phishing and how to stay safe online. Each task provided practical experience and improved my confidence in using technology. Overall, this project has helped me build essential skills that will be useful for my studies, future career, and responsible use of digital platforms.

References:

- Canva – https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – https://github.com
- LinkedIn – https://www.linkedin.com
- Stack Overflow – https://stackoverflow.com
- HackerRank – https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline (India) – 1930
- Digital Literacy Project Brief (Course Material)

THE END